

CITA01 – FOUNDATIONS OF CITY STUDIES SUMMER 2026

AUGUST 6, 2026

COURSE INSTRUCTOR: OLIVIA BERNARD





Objectives

Office
Hours

Final Exam
Review

Course
Evaluation

COURSE EVALUATION

Please remember to
complete the course
evaluations.

They are beneficial in
providing feedback
on the strengths and
weaknesses of the
course.

OFFICE HOURS

- August 19th – 1 to 2pm.

- Topic: CITA01 - Office Hours

Time: Aug 19, 2026 01:00 PM America/Toronto

- Join Zoom Meeting
- <https://utoronto.zoom.us/j/83146493803>
- Meeting ID: 831 4649 3803

FINAL EXAM



August 20, 2026



2-hour exam



9am – 11am



Quercus Quiz

FINAL EXAM



8 QUESTIONS, CHOOSE 6



CASE STUDIES



MISSED EXAMS WILL
NEED TO GO THROUGH
THE REGISTRAR'S OFFICE

FINAL EXAM



250 WORDS RESPONSES



WORTH 30% OF YOUR
MARKS



DRAW ON COURSE
ARTICLES, VIDEOS AND
LECTURES

QUESTIONS?



SAMPLE CASE

Toronto has experienced an increase in homeless encampments in public parks and open spaces, including Trinity Bellwoods Park and Alexandra Park. In response, some residents and city officials have called for the removal of encampments, citing concerns about safety and access to public space. Others argue that the growth of encampments reflects broader challenges such as rising housing costs, poverty, and shifts toward neoliberal housing policies that increasingly treat housing as a commodity rather than a social good. Critics of encampment clearances argue that removing encampments does not address the underlying causes of homelessness and housing insecurity.

SAMPLE QUESTION

Question (respond in 250 words)

- Drawing on the concepts of social exclusion and the right to the city, explain what the presence of encampments in Toronto suggests about access to housing, public space, and urban resources. Why might clearing encampments fail to address the broader issues contributing to homelessness and housing insecurity? Drawing on the UN-Habitat reading, discuss one policy or intervention that addresses these underlying causes.

HOW WOULD WE BEGIN?

Identify key terms or areas to discuss:

- Social exclusion and isolation
 - Housing affordability and commodification of housing. Neoliberalism
 - Rise in informal settlements and encampments
 - Right to the city – participation in the community, city planning and having a voice
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- Welcome to India and Tent City as examples to mention and connect to the two provided in the case study
 - 3 short paragraph structure to ensure we address the three sections of the question.

WHICH SOURCES SHOULD WE USE?

Week 3 and week 6 lectures:

- Un habitat for the intervention and informal settlement discussion
- Madanipour on socio-spatial exclusion
- Adeniyi-Ogunyankin et al for the growth in informal settlements and connect to the right to the city
- While this is not mandatory, we could use Massey to connect to discussions of power geometry and access to space

STRUCTURING YOUR RESPONSE

First section:

- Briefly discuss informal settlements according to UN-Habitat or Adeniyi-Ogunyankin et al., and note that informal settlements are, in part, a consequence of social exclusion.
- Mention *Welcome to India* (which connects to the case through the government's response of demolition, or another relevant factor) and Tent City (a direct connection to Toronto that, like the examples in the case study, illustrates the increasing prevalence of informal settlements and encampments in urban spaces).
- Encampments and informal settlements are connected to the commodification of housing and the lack of access to affordable housing. We need to move beyond individual blame or clearance approaches, as seen in the cases above, and instead understand how power (Massey) and exclusion (Madanipour) shape access to housing.

STRUCTURING YOUR RESPONSE

Second section:

- Briefly discuss exclusion according to Madanipour. Mention the three forms: economic exclusion (income or access to adequate employment), socio-spatial exclusion (access to parks, the use of city signage to deter unhoused folks, or defensive architecture), and political exclusion (who has meaningful participation in urban decision-making processes).
- This provides a direct connection to the Right to the City and offers a brief discussion that demonstrates your understanding of how these topics are linked. Mention Adeniyi-Ogunyankin or draw on our lecture discussion of the Right to the City, and connect these ideas to the case.

STRUCTURING YOUR RESPONSE

Third section:

- How can the government address the issue and move beyond clearance as a measure? We need to address the economic and social dimensions of poverty by tackling its root causes. Connect this discussion to UN-Habitat.
- Connect to a UN-Habitat policy or intervention, such as rent subsidies, rent ceilings, zoning policies that support the development of affordable housing, and investment in infrastructure that aligns with the needs of residents in informal settlements.
- The policies discussed also address the various dimensions of poverty, including employment and income, food security, health and education, shelter, and access to basic urban infrastructure and services.

STRUCTURING YOUR RESPONSE

- Of course, it is not expected that all of these details would be included within the exam's limited word count.
- These are the key points we worked through in the lecture to demonstrate both how to break down the question and how to construct an effective response.
- Good luck on the exam!

Next Steps

Final Exam

- August 20th
- 9-11a.m
- The Zoom link will be sent as an announcement closer to the date.

